
CLIENT DELIVERY SYSTEM

VIDEO TREATMENT

Brief, shot list, call sheet, deliverables

Owner: Claude drafts from intake. Devon approves and shoots.

Fill this in, don't invent it. Everything below comes from the intake — especially section B, where the owner's own words are written verbatim. Those words are the film.

THE RULE THAT GOVERNS EVERYTHING HERE

A brand story film is proof, not advertising. The customer is buying a promise about work that doesn't exist yet, from someone they met once. The film's only job is to make that promise credible.

So: real crew, real work, real voice. No stock. No "we're passionate about quality." If a line could appear on any competitor's site, cut it.

PART 1 — THE BRIEF [FILL FROM INTAKE]

Client:

Trade:

Shoot date:

Location(s):

On-camera person:

The one thing a viewer should believe after 90 seconds:

(One sentence. Not three. Something like: "These people will show up when they say, and my place will end up looking like that.")

Who's watching:

(Homeowner mid-research? Facility manager? Be specific — it changes the tone.)

The fear we're answering:

(Every trade has one — "will it last," "will they show up," "will they disappear halfway," "will it cost double what they quoted." Name theirs, then answer it on camera.)

Their actual words *(verbatim from intake B — do not clean these up):*

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PART 2 — STRUCTURE

Default 90 seconds. Five beats.

BEAT	SEC	WHAT HAPPENS
1. The hook	0–8	The most visually arresting thing on the job. Not a logo. Not a drone shot of the town. The work.
2. Who they are	8–25	Owner on camera, in their space. Name, trade, how long. Plain.
3. The problem they solve	25–50	The fear, named and answered. Cut to work that proves it.
4. Proof	50–75	Process, crew, craft. The unglamorous competence. This is the part that sells.
5. The close	75–90	Owner, direct to camera, one sentence. Then logo + phone.

Cutdowns from the same shoot — plan these on the day, don't reframe later:

- **9:16 × 3** (15–30s) for ads — hook must land in 2 seconds
- **6s bumper** — one shot, one line, logo

PART 3 — SHOT LIST & B-ROLL

Works for any trade. The structure below doesn't change; what fills it does.

● = **the money shot**. If the day falls apart, get these. VERT = **shoot 9:16 natively** on the day. Reframed 16:9 always looks reframed.

First: find this client's money shot

Every trade has one moment that is genuinely satisfying to watch and that competitors never film. Find it before the shoot by asking the owner two questions:

1. "What part of the job would someone stop and watch?"
2. "What do you do that a bad crew skips?"

The answer to #1 is your hook. The answer to #2 is your proof. Everything else is coverage.

If they can't answer, look for the moment where **the material changes state** — liquid to solid, loose to taut, rough to smooth, broken to whole. That's almost always it.

The universal list

A. Before ●

- ☐ ● The starting state — **locked-off tripod, tape the legs, note lens and height.**

You will need this exact frame again and cannot recreate it later.

- ☐ Detail of the problem: the wear, damage, dated finish, whatever they're being paid to fix
- ☐ Wide establishing of the property or space

B. Arrival and setup

- ☐ ● Truck arriving, door opening, boots down

- ☐ Tools coming off the rack
- ☐ Protective covering going down — *a trust shot; almost nobody films it and customers notice it*
- ☐ Measuring, marking, checking

C. The process ● — most of your footage

- ☐ ● **VERT** **The money shot** , 4–5 takes, multiple angles
- ☐ ● The state change itself, close and slow
- ☐ Hands working — no face, just competence
- ☐ The tool doing its job, tight
- ☐ Material texture, macro
- ☐ ● Two people on one task — crews read as capable, soloists read as small
- ☐ **VERT** Wide of the whole operation

D. After ●

- ☐ ● **The exact locked-off before frame** , finished. Same lens, height, position
- ☐ ● Light raking across the finished work
- ☐ Detail: the edge, the joint, the seam — where quality actually shows
- ☐ The tactile proof — a hand testing it, pressing it, running along it
- ☐ ● Clean-up: vacuum, broom, wiping down. *"They left it spotless" is what customers repeat*
- ☐ **VERT** Slow push or walk through the finished result

E. Human ●

- ☐ Owner in their space, working
- ☐ Crew talking something through, pointing at the work
- ☐ ● One genuine unguarded moment — someone laughing. *Beats ten posed ones*
- ☐ ● Owner looking at the finished work — the face, not the words
- ☐ Logo on truck or shirt, shallow depth

Reference — where the money shot usually lives

Starting points only. Confirm with the owner; they know better than this table.

TRADE	LIKELY HOOK	THE STATE CHANGE
Coatings / epoxy	Decorative flake thrown mid-air, side-lit	Liquid resin curing hard
Screen enclosure	Spline roller running the channel	Sagging → taut
Remodel	Dust sheet pulled back	Demo → finished room
Roofing	Tear-off, material coming away	Worn → sealed
Painting	First cut-in line, brush edge	Patchy → clean
Landscaping	Fresh edge cut into turf	Overgrown → shaped
HVAC / plumbing	The failed part vs the new one, side by side	Broken → running

TRADE	LIKELY HOOK	THE STATE CHANGE
Concrete	Screed pull across wet pour	Wet → set
Detailing / cleaning	The half-and-half pass	Filthy → clean

When the job has no visible transformation — service calls, inspections, consultations — the film leans on people instead: the interview carries it, and b-roll becomes hands, tools, truck, and the customer conversation. Shoot more interview, not more coverage.

Marking the before frame

Tape the tripod legs. Note lens, height, position. A matched before/after from the identical position is worth more than any other pair of shots on the job, and it is the one thing you physically cannot recreate once the work is done.

PART 4 — INTERVIEW QUESTIONS

Ask these. Let them ramble. The usable line is almost always the third sentence of an answer, after they stop performing.

1. Tell me what you do, like you're telling a neighbor.
2. How'd you get into this?
3. What's the part of the job most people don't see?
4. What do customers worry about before they call you?
5. What do you do differently from the guy down the road?
6. Tell me about a job you're proud of.
7. What goes wrong on a bad job — and what do you do about it?
8. Why should someone pick you?

Q7 is the most valuable question on this list. Everyone answers 5 and 8 with a slogan. Nobody rehearses 7, so that's where the credible answer lives.

Never feed them lines. If they say something great, ask them to say it again — don't say it for them.

PART 5 — CALL SHEET [SEND 48H BEFORE]

Date / call time / wrap:

Address:

Contact on site + mobile:

Who needs to be there:

What the client must have ready:

- Site clean and presentable — the space, vehicles, uniforms
- Anyone on camera dressed the way they'd meet a customer

- Access to any locked areas
- A job actually in progress if at all possible

What Devon brings:

- Camera, lenses, support
- Lav + shotgun audio
- Lights
- Backup media, batteries charged
- Release forms

Weather backup:

PART 6 — DELIVERABLES

DELIVERABLE	SPEC	WHERE IT'S USED
Brand story master	16:9, 60–90s	Landing page hero, GBP, YouTube
Vertical cutdowns × 3	9:16, 15–30s	Meta ads
Bumper	6s	Retargeting, pre-roll
Stills	20–30	Landing page, GBP photos, ads

Turnaround: first cut within 7 days of shoot. One revision round included.

Say this out loud when you deliver: the stills matter as much as the film. GBP photos are a ranking and conversion input, and most competitors have none.

RULES

1. **Never script the owner.** Ask questions, cut the answers.
2. **Over-shoot b-roll.** You'll never wish you had less. Every ad for the next year comes from this day.
3. **Shoot vertical on the day.** Reframed 16:9 always looks reframed.
4. **No stock footage. Ever.** The entire point is that this is real.
5. **If the site is a mess, reschedule or clean it.** You cannot fix it in the edit, and the client

will blame the film.